



CYBER FOUNDATION & CTF MINDSET

CGH-X

MODULE 1 — CLASS 1

Cyber Foundation & CTF Mindset

LEARN. PRACTICE. ATTACK. DEFEND. LEAD.



Put your phone on the table.



YOUR LEARNING COMMUNITY

The path is built for beginners.

Two communities. One practical cybersecurity journey.

CyberHELP

Secure Help. Anytime. Anywhere.

Learn with clear guidance, real tools, and a community built to help you begin.

FIRE Cybersecurity Community

For Intelligence, Resilience, and Empowerment

Build the mindset to investigate, practice ethically, and keep improving.

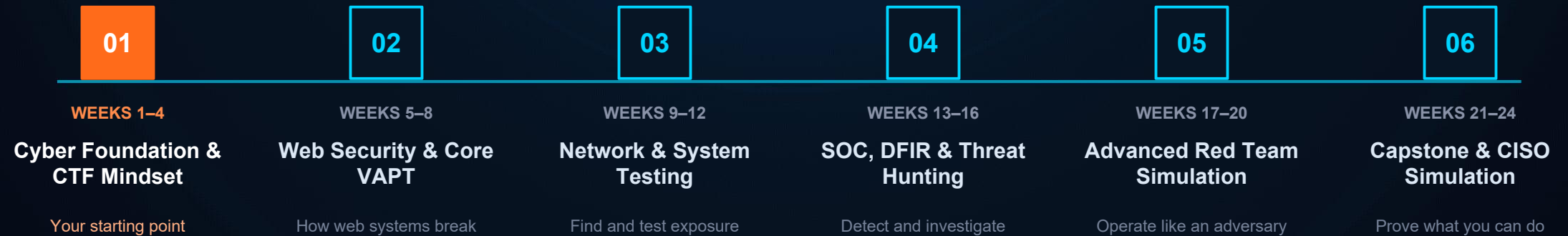
HANDS-ON. CTF-DRIVEN. JOB-FOCUSED.



THE CGH-X JOURNEY

One foundation. Six stages.

24 WEEKS · ONE PROGRESSION



Today: establish the mindset, the rules, and the first tools.

YOU ARE HERE → MODULE 1



SECTION 01 — CTF MINDSET

CTFs turn curiosity into skill.

You learn by solving controlled challenges, one clue at a time.

THIS IS WHAT WE DO

Jeopardy style

Solve independent challenges. Find the flag. Earn points.

ONE PROBLEM → ONE BREAKTHROUGH

THE CHALLENGE CATEGORIES YOU WILL MEET

WEB

Web

CRYPTO

Crypto

FORENSICS

Forensics

RE

Reverse Engineering

PWN

Binary Exploitation

OSINT

Open-Source Intel

LATER

Attack–Defense

Attack other teams while defending your own services.

OFFENSE + DEFENSE AT ONCE



ETHICS BEFORE EXPLOITS

The rules protect the learning.

Respect the scope. Respect the people behind the systems.

!

Never share flags

!

Never attack anything you
were not given

!

Never scan outside the lab

THM{y0u_f0und_1t}

The flag is the proof. **Permission is the boundary.**



LINUX SURVIVAL

Eight commands unlock today's lab.

Type them. Test them. Remember them.

pwd Where am I?	ls -la Show everything, including hidden.	cd Move around folders.	cat Read a file.
file Identify the file type.	strings Find readable text inside.	grep Search inside files.	find Locate files anywhere.



WRITE IT DOWN

Professionals document the work.

A clean writeup makes your thinking visible — to you, your team, and your future employer.

Screenshot this slide.

Use this structure after every challenge, even the small ones.

WRITEUP_TEMPLATE.md

KEEP IT SHORT · KEEP IT HONEST

Challenge:

What I saw:

What I tried — including what FAILED:

THIS LINE IS THE WHOLE POINT.

What worked:

Command used:



CTF MAP

The categories.

Different puzzles. One habit: observe first, then test a hypothesis.

01 / WEB Web	02 / CRYPTO Crypto	03 / FORENSICS Forensics
04 / RE Reverse Engineering	05 / PWN PWN Binary Exploitation	06 / OSINT OSINT Open-Source Intelligence



THE TARGET

What a flag looks like.

```
THM{y0u_f0und_1t}
```

This is what you're hunting. **Nothing else counts.**



ETHICS FIRST The rules.

The lab is a privilege. Treat it that way.

!

Never share flags

!

**Never attack anything you
weren't given**

!

Never scan outside the lab

Permission defines the playground.



THE LINE THAT MATTERS

“The difference between a security professional and a criminal is **written permission.”**

Skill is not the boundary. **Permission** is.



RECOVERY WORKFLOW

The Stuck Protocol.

Screenshot this slide. Frustration is normal; the next action should be deliberate.

DO NOT SKIP TO THE ANSWER.

A professional records evidence, tests a concept, and asks for help with context.

01

Try alone — 15 minutes

Make a hypothesis. Test it. Observe the result.

02

Re-read the challenge description

The clue is often already in the wording.

03

Search the concept, not the challenge name

Learn the method, not someone else's solution.

04

Ask the group

Include what you already tried and what happened.

05

Then ask the instructor

Bring your evidence. Ask one precise question.



SECTION 02 — HANDS-ON BASICS

LINUX SURVIVAL

8 commands. That's all you need today.

TYPE → OBSERVE → REPEAT



LINUX SURVIVAL

The 8 commands.

That's all you need today.

pwd Where am I?	ls -la Show everything, including hidden.	cd Move around folders.	cat Read a file.
file What type is this?	strings Readable text inside a binary.	grep Search inside files.	find Locate files anywhere.



LINUX RECONNAISSANCE

Why an attacker cares.

The command is only the start.

COMMAND	WHY IT MATTERS
<code>ls -la</code>	→ Hidden files are where flags live.
<code>strings</code>	→ The fastest first look inside any binary.
<code>grep -r</code>	→ Beats opening files one by one .
<code>find</code>	→ Finds the thing when you don't know where it is .

LOOK WIDER. SEARCH SMARTER. FOLLOW THE CLUE.



RESOURCE ALERT

!

DO NOT START THE **ATTACKBOX** YET.

Free accounts get about **1 hour per day**.
You'll need it later in this class.

KEEP THE TIME. USE IT WHEN THE LAB REQUIRES IT.



DashboardLearnPracticeCompete

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[← Back to all walkthroughs](#)



Linux Fundamentals (Pt1)

Embark on the journey of learning the fundamentals of Linux. Learn to run some of the first essential commands on an interactive terminal.

 15 min  322

Save RoomRecommend 6ConnectivityOptions

Room progress: 0%

Task 1 ☐ Introduction

Set up your virtual environment

To successfully complete this room, you'll need to set up your virtual environment. This involves starting the Lab Machine, ensuring you're equipped with the necessary tools and access to tackle the challenges ahead.



LAB 1 — LIVE PRACTICE

TryHackMe → Linux Fundamentals Part 1

Your first command-line lab.

- 01 Runs in your **browser** — nothing to install.
- 02 Type **every command** yourself.
- 03 Answer the room's questions as you go.



SECTION 03 — LIVE PRACTICE

YOUR FIRST FLAG

Everyone. **Own hands.** No exceptions.

NO COPY / NO GUESS / FIND THE EVIDENCE



DashboardLearnPracticeCompete

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Learn > OhSINT



OhSINT

Are you able to use open source intelligence to solve this challenge?

60 min249,392

BadgeHelpSave Room5515 Recommend

Room progress: 0%

To access material, start machines and answer questions you need to join this room!

Join Room

Video

OhSINT | TryHackMe Walkthrough Challenge 2026

Source: YouTube

LAB 2 — LIVE PRACTICE

TryHackMe → OhSINT

Use open-source evidence. Follow the clues.

- 01 Remember the **photo** from the start of class.
- 02 Task 1 together, then **you run**.
- 03 Record the clue that changed your next move.



STRETCH CHALLENGE

PICKLE RICK

Finished early? Keep exploring.

A web app hides three ingredients. Your task is to find them by observing carefully and thinking one step at a time.

01

Three ingredients are hidden in a web app.

02

The first one is **easier than you think.**

03

Look at the page.
Really look at it.



SECTION 04 — PROFESSIONAL HABITS

WRITE IT DOWN

This is what separates a hobbyist from a professional.

TURN YOUR STEPS INTO EVIDENCE.



WRITE IT DOWN

The writeup template.

A clean writeup makes your thinking visible — to you, your team, and your future employer.

Screenshot this slide.

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BEFORE NEXT CLASS

Homework.

Practice the basics while the commands and clues are still fresh.

**ROUGHLY 2 HOURS
OF FOCUSED WORK.**

YOUR CHECKLIST

- | | | |
|--------------------------|--|-----------------|
| ☐ | Finish Linux Fundamentals Part 1 | REQUIRED |
| ☐ | Complete OhSINT | REQUIRED |
| ☐ | Write 2 writeups using the template | REQUIRED |
| ☐ | OverTheWire — Bandit levels 0 to 5 | OPTIONAL |



COMMUNITY PROGRESS

THE SCOREBOARD IS LIVE.

LIVE EDITABLE TABLE

Complete the rooms. Record the work. Move up together.

RANK	NAME	ROOMS COMPLETED
01	[learner name]	[00]
02	[learner name]	[00]
03	[learner name]	[00]
04	[learner name]	[00]

UPDATED AFTER EVERY CLASS.

1:22–1:26



CLASS 2 SIGNAL

Y2xhc3MgMiBpcyBjb21pbmc=

This isn't encrypted. It isn't even hidden.

Next class: why base64 protects nothing.



CLASS 1 COMPLETE

SEE YOU NEXT CLASS

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CyberHELP × FIRE Cybersecurity Community

Thank you for learning, practicing, and showing up.

TRAIN. PRACTICE. PROTECT.